



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

FEB 2018

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for March is

February 16

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011



February

SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:15 am Education and Fellowship.

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in February

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
				1 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a World Religions - Catholic & Orthodox 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Play Reh.	2 <i>Groundhog Day</i> 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	3 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Set building
4 <i>Super Bowl</i> Communion 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 6p Play Reh. 7p SAA	5 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Play Reh. 6:30p What Do United Methodists Believe? <i>Sacraments</i>	6 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 5:30p Play Reh. 6:30p Toastmasters	7 10a Staff Meeting 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	8 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a World Religions - Protestants 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 5:30p Play Reh.	9 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6p Play Reh. 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	10 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2p Snow White 7p Snow White
11 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 2p Snow White 2p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	12 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p What Do United Methodists Believe? <i>All of the above.</i>	13 <i>Mardi Gras</i> 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Nokomis Neighborhood Group	14 <i>Valentine's Day/ Ash Wednesday</i> 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:30 Ash Wednesday Service 6:45p Chancel Choir	15 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	16 <i>Newsletter items due</i> 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	17 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
18 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 7p SAA	19 <i>Presidents' Day</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Hope/Action	20 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	21 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir	22 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Hope/Action 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	23 9a Brighter Minds 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	24 7a MinneHarvest 8:30a Minnehaha Family Book Club 9a Roosevelt Selection Committee 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Ukelele Workshop
25 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Confirmation Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	26 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Hope/Action	27 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR <i>Fellowship Hall Reserved for Funeral Set-up in the evening</i>	28 2p Phyllis Matz Memorial 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir <i>Fellowship Hall Reserved for Auction</i>	Notes: <i>The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.</i>		

Worship in February

February is a transition month this year. We finish the season of Epiphany and move into the season of Lent. We'll have the last of our social justice themes – the environment – on February 4, celebrate camping on February 11, and then Ash Wednesday falls on February 14 (yup, that's right, Valentine's Day is also Ash Wednesday – to make it even more interesting, April Fool's Day is Easter). We'll be looking at unusual gifts during the season of Lent, utilizing ideas from a book called Gifts of the Dark Wood. We'll explore how things like temptation and being uncertain can contain within them the seeds for a closer relationship with God. See you in worship!

4th **“Social Justice—Environmentalism”**

11th **Camping Sunday**

14th **Ash Wednesday**

18th **Gifts of the Dark Wood**

25th **Gifts of the Dark Wood**

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

Feb. 14 – Ash Wednesday (Lent begins)

March 3 – Auction

March 11 – Daylight Savings begins
(spring ahead)

March 24 – First annual Talent Show
and Dessert Auction

March 29 – Maundy Thursday

March 30 – Good Friday

April 1 – Easter Sunday

May 20—One Service 10:00 Children's
Musical

The Minnehaha Players proudly present

The Rockin' Tale of Snow White

Saturday, 10th February at 2pm and 7pm

Sunday, 11th February at 2pm

Tickets: \$10 for adults, \$6 for kids 12 & under,
\$25 family cap

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417

www.minnehaha.org

Profits go to support UMW Missions
for Women & Children – Locally & Globally

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

February 16

Youth Ministries

Here is a look forward at the next month for our Youth ministries program. We have a lot of activities coming up for our Youth and volunteers with opportunities to Seek, Serve, and to Celebrate! All the things we do best here at Minnehaha.

February 4th - Super Bowl "Subs for Scholarships" Sunday: Youth will be meeting in the church kitchen at 8:30am to prepare sub sandwiches that will be for sale after both services. Proceeds will go to help youth camps and scholarships, so please stop by the Narthex after worship and pick up the family some sub sandwiches for lunch!

***No evening Confirmation classes – Enjoy the Game!**

February 11th – Camp Sunday: This will be a very busy day for Youth! We are asking youth to participate in worship by sharing their favorite camp experiences as well as helping lead a camp song. After worship we will be having a Bake sale in the narthex to raise money for our Youth Camps.

– Youth Night: From 4-6pm we will be filming our next Snack Crates videos as well as having a game night!

February 13th – Fat Tuesday: We will be getting together to discuss and celebrate Shrove Tuesday/ Fat Tuesday while making and eating pancakes! There is no cost, but all are welcome to bring their favorite pancake toppings to share with the group! We will meet in the kitchen from 4:00-5:30pm.

February 18th – No Confirmation Classes: Presidents Day Weekend

February 24th – MinneHarvest: Youth and families are getting together to volunteer with MinneHarvest. One out of every six Minnesotans are food insecure and our Youth have decided they wanted to help feed those in need. There is two separate times that we could use help, come early and help unload the food truck at 7am, or come later at 9am to help with food distribution and clean up.

February 25th – Confirmation Night: Goes from 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be discussing *Making Good Decisions*.

March 3rd – Church Auction: Youth are serving Breakfast and Lunch again this year! We will be becoming authentic baristas in the kitchen, serving all kinds of coffee treats, as well as serving lunch from 10am-2pm. Breakfast is from 10-12, and lunch 12-2. Even if you can only come for a little while, please come and join us!

March 4th – Confirmation Night: Goes from 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be finishing the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be discussing *Grace & Sin / Heaven & Hell*.

March 11th – Youth Night: Goes from 3:00-6:00pm. Youth will be playing Broomball at McRae park.
**Friends are always welcome to join us!
And we can still use a extra chaperone or two!**

Leilani Thompson
Director of Youth Ministries



Children's Ministries

Children's Ministries

At our annual Winter Retreat, people from all ages gathered at Lake Koronis to explore the theme Fill My Cup. We focused on three things: listening, prioritizing, and embracing winter. As we move into Lent this month, we'll contemplate the *Gifts of the Dark Wood*. Notice a trend? There is wilderness and darkness in our world, in the world our children dwell. How much do we share this with them? What is the right amount to keep them safe and preserve their childhood? What is the right amount to allow them to grow and be aware and ready to do the work of peace and justice?

When the leaves have all fallen from trees, leaving the branches bare, when the earth is frozen, and the hours of daylight are few: life is different. There is a quiet to it, that makes every sound, every need, louder. We work to create our own light and warmth in the world.

When we find ourselves in the wilderness (whether by our own choice or not): life is different. We listen differently. We feel differently. Being with our children in the winter and in the wilderness is an important part of their faith development, and to ours as well. The world is not all butterflies and rainbows and Christmas cookies. But, God is with us when we see no life around us. God is with us when civilization seems far away. God is with us. And, we can let our children know that we will do our best to be with them, too.

One opportunity we have to explore bringing light to a dark world this Lent is through our first ever Minnehaha Family Book Club. During the month of February we encourage you to read the book *The Tale of Despereaux* by Kate DiCamillo together as a family. This book tells the story of a mouse named Despereaux who loves light and music and song, and while forced to live in a dark world, holds fervently onto his faith in the light, and is determined to share it. Then, on Saturday, February 24th, we'll gather to talk about the book and will have some activities based on this wonderful story. If your family is not quite ready for chapter books, we still invite you to join us for the book club morning, and we'll have a group looking at the picture book *The Knight and the Dragon* by Tomie DePaolo together.

One way we bring light into the world is by recognizing the dignity of one another. During the season of Lent, we'll be collecting items for the Food Shelf. Each week, we'll be focusing on different products - things like soap

and shaving cream and toothbrushes. Elsewhere in this newsletter, and posted in the church, is the schedule for which items we'll be focusing on each week. Consider taking your child (ren) with you to shop for these items, and talk about how this act of service is a way to be God's hands in the world.

And, speaking of wilderness, on Sunday, February 11th, we'll celebrate how camping programs give us opportunities to grow our relationship with God. We'll have special worship services and information & registration available for Minnehaha's various camping programs - both onsite and away.

We hope you'll join us for these opportunities and more. As always, please let me know if you have any questions about our ministries.

Jenia Strom
Director of Children & Family Ministries

The Peace of Wild Things

by Wendell Berry

When despair for the world grows in me
and I wake in the night at the least sound
in fear of what my life and my children's lives may be,
I go and lie down where the wood drake
rests in his beauty on the water, and the great heron feeds.

I come into the peace of wild things
who do not tax their lives with forethought
of grief. I come into the presence of still water.
And I feel above me the day-blind stars
waiting with their light.
For a time
I rest in the grace of the world, and am free.



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Children's Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

Highlights from the January 9 Church Council Meeting

TREASURER'S REPORT: Based on our Treasurer's reckoning, 2017 was a good year for the church. Revenues were higher than projected (101.5%) and expenditures were lower than projected (97.4%). As a result, we ended the year with a surplus! Plus, the amount owed on our mortgage dropped to \$342,782. We are current with all bills, mortgage payments, apportionment payments and inter-fund loan payments through the end of the year. Also, several church members have made advance payments for 2018, putting us in a strong cash flow position for the coming year. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

2017 A "TURNAROUND" YEAR FOR MUMC: Finance Chair Sue Claude called 2017 a "Turnaround" year for the church financially. She highlighted growing contributions from the congregation, steady rental income and good management of expenses as the key reasons. Sue is optimistic that 2018 will be a year of "Growth" for Minnehaha UMC. (Sue Claude, Finance)

2018 BUDGET UNANIMOUSLY SUPPORTED BY CHURCH COUNCIL: Finance Chair Sue Claude outlined some additional expenses that will affect the church's 2018 budget, including higher healthcare costs, increased hours for our custodian, modest salary increases, increased apportionment payments and the need to replace some of our computers. On the plus side, she noted that pledges are up more than \$16,000 for the coming year, and that we ended 2017 with a surplus. As a result, Sue presented a comprehensive 2018 budget of just over \$421,000. In order to balance the budget, we will use part of the 2017 surplus. That means no special appeal, such as the numbered envelope or blue mug campaigns, is scheduled for 2018. Sue concluded that, "We have a strong, active, committed and GROWING membership." The Church Council unanimously voted to submit the proposed budget to the congregation at the Annual Meeting and Church Conference on January 21. (Sue Claude, Finance)

TRUSTEES' PLANS FOR 2018: GYM? FELLOWSHIP HALL?: The Board of Trustees is looking to do a major project in 2018. They are deciding between fixing up the gym (replacing the gym wall) or upgrading the Fellowship Hall, including new technology and lighting. Trustees Chair Kim Kanuit noted that the church was just given a large gift by an anonymous donor to improve the Fellowship Hall. (Thank you!) As a result, Trustees will evaluate if it might be possible to move forward on both projects in the coming year. Stay tuned. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

MINNEHAHA MUSICAL ON FEB. 10 & 11: The Minnehaha Players proudly present the family musical "The Rockin' Tale of Snow White." The three shows will be on: Saturday, February 10 at 2:00 and 7:00 p.m.; and Sunday February 11 at 2:00 p.m. Tickets are \$10 for adults and \$6 for kids 12 & under. (\$25 family cap.) Proceeds support missions for women and children. (Maureen Trepp, United Methodist Women)

FOOD SHELF SERVES 524 CLIENTS: As of the end of 2017, the Minnehaha Food Shelf has 524 registered clients. Total numbers (including family members) are: 565 adults, 275 children and 134 seniors. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)

THANKS TO THE RIVERVIEW THEATER AND FAT LORENZO'S: The Riverview Theater and Fat Lorenzo's are long-time supporters of the Minnehaha Food Shelf, which is housed at Minnehaha UMC. The Riverview's Five Days of Christmas Movies generated 2,598 lbs. of food and cash donations totaling \$734.25; the theater also donated \$1,818.30, which were the proceeds from ticket sales. On January 10, Fat Lorenzo's provided enough pasta and salad to feed more than 350 people at the annual pasta dinner, which is the Minnehaha Food Shelf's biggest fundraiser of the year. Support these businesses that support our community, and thank them for their generosity. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)

THE COUNCIL WILL NOT MEET IN FEBRUARY. COMMITTEE CHAIRS ARE TAKING A MUCH-NEEDED BREAK.

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, outgoing Church Council Chair

Christmas Offering

Thanks to your generous response to our Christmas letter, \$4,300 came in, 10% of which (\$430) we were able to give to our food ministries.

Adult Classes

Did you know that the United Methodist Church has official beliefs about the environment and how we interact with God's Creation? This Lenten season, we'll take a closer look at what those beliefs are in a 6-week class that looks closely at the Pastoral Letter from the Council of Bishops entitled God's Renewed Creation: Call to Hope and Action. The class will be held on both Monday evenings from 6:30-8, starting 2/19, and Thursday mornings from 10-11:30, starting 2/22. There is no need to do any reading beforehand, just come to class ready to engage with each other around the topic.

Interested in learning more about how Christians can contribute to the growing environmental movement? In February, we will be exploring this theme in both worship service, as well as in adult study classes. If you are interested in going deeper, Garrett Evangelical Theological Seminary and Hennepin Avenue United Methodist Church are co-sponsoring a one-day workshop on 2/17. This workshop will be led by Rev. Dr. Timothy Eberhart, a professor at Garrett, an elder in the Dakotas Annual Conference, and a good friend and mentor to our deacon, Rev. Hope Hutchison. More information about this event can be found here: <https://www.garrett.edu/regional-offerings/hope-creation-minneapolis>

Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., there is a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of some kind around current events in the world or in the church. In February we will be gathering on February 8.

Ash Wednesday

Lent begins on Wednesday, February 14 this year, and we will be starting our Lenten observance with an Ash Wednesday service at 6:30 p.m. If you've never been to an Ash Wednesday service before, this is a more solemn service that includes ashes made from the burning of palms from last year's Palm Sunday. We "impose" the ashes as a reminder of how sometimes even our best intentions can go awry, and as a reminder of our own mortality. All ages are invited to participate in the service. There will be a dinner from 5:30-6:15 that same evening.

Minnehaha Family Book Club Saturday, 24th February, 9:30-11:30am



Stories are light. Light is precious in a world so dark.
Begin at the beginning. Tell...a story. Make some light.
- *The Tale of Despereaux*

Families Interested in
Reading a Chapter Book

We'll read Kate DiCamillo's
The Tale of Despereaux



For this story, read it *before* coming on Saturday, and we'll have conversation and stories based around this amazing book.

Families with Younger Children:

We'll read Tomie De Paola's
The Knight and the Dragon



For this story, no need to read ahead – join us Saturday morning for story time and for activities around this wonderful book.

Minnehaha United Methodist Church – 3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417

www.minnehaha.org 612.721.6231

Questions? Contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org



Steve Meier, Tim Siefkes, and Kitty Campbell all received service awards during United Methodist Women's Sunday



United Methodist Women

- Interested in a Circle? There is a very great group of women meeting on the second Wednesday morning of the month at Nokomis Square who are the Nokomis Circle; if you are interested, please let Rachel Larson or Joanne Becklund know that you would like to come at 9:30. The Susannah Circle meets on Thursday evenings after the kids are put to bed; Jenia Strom is the chairman so let her know that would be a Circle you would like to attend. The Wenonah Circle helps out in serving and preparing for events at church so you would be contacted when an event comes up; Kim Kanuit is the contact person for Wenonah.
- The UMW also sponsors serving at Simpson Shelter with men and women helping prepare and serve meals to the folks who come to Simpson on 28th St. E. and 1st Ave in south Minneapolis. If you are interested in serving, we have dates coming up in Feb. and March: the 26ths of both months, Monday evenings. We meet at Simpson around 5:45 and serve until about 8:00. Please let Maureen Trepp at 612-724-7620 know if you are interested in helping out; we also need someone to prepare the meal ahead of time.
- Our wonderful all ages, all church musical is also sponsored by your UMW and "The Rockin' Tale of Snow White" will be performed on Sat., Feb. 10 at 2:00 and 7:00 and on Sun, Feb. 11 at 2:00: a fun, child-filled show with rollicking' songs. We are also sending several UMW members to the National Conference in Columbus, Ohio on May 18-20 and have saved money to help defray the costs of attending. Please let Maureen or Kim know if you are planning on going so you can be reimbursed and also so we can get hotel rooms together.

Food Ministries

MUMC supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.



Lenten Personal Dignity Drive to benefit the Minnehaha Food Shelf

*Consider bringing the following items with you to worship,
or dropping them off at Minnehaha any time throughout the season.*

February 18th-24th: Toothpaste and Toothbrushes
 February 25th-March 3rd: Toilet Paper
 March 4th-10th: Soap - Bar Soap, Shampoo, and Conditioner
 March 11th-17th: Deodorant, Razors, and Shaving Cream
 March 18th-24th: Feminine Hygiene Products & Newborn-Sized Diapers
 Palm Sunday, March 25th: Food Donations

Minnehaha UMC
Lent 2018
Gifts of the Dark Wood

First Friday Films

Do you find yourself shouting advice to characters during a movie? Nudging your neighbor with an elbow during critical scenes? Wishing you had someone to talk to about the movie you just watched? Then you are in luck! Come to the church on the first Friday of the month at 7:00 and settle in to the comfy furniture in the youth room to watch a movie. Bring your own beverage and snacks, bring a friend if you want, and get ready to watch a movie with other Minnehaha-ians. After the credits roll, you'll have an opportunity to share your "aha" moments, the things you liked or disliked, or anything else the movie prompted in you.

Our first movie will be on Friday, February 2, and we'll watch *Trade*, which is about a Texas cop (Kevin Kline), whose own daughter might have been forced into sexual slavery, joins forces with a Mexican youth (Cesar Ramos) to find the boy's sister, who was abducted and forced into prostitution. Meanwhile, a Ukrainian woman who was promised a better life in America also becomes a victim.

Save the Date!!

Saturday, March 24th! Evening Entertaining and Dessert Auction! We will be featuring our own "home-grown" talent - young and older alike for the entertainment, and our famous Dessert Auction returns as well!

Brush off your tap shoes, polish up that baton again for some twirling or find some friends to play or sing together as an ensemble. We're look for all types of entertainment. Find Julia Cook to let her know what talent you would like to share with us, and see Annette Meier about donating a decadent dessert for our auction.

More details to come throughout February!

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us this month on February 9 for a time of renewal.

MINNEHAHA LOCAL PIZZERIA POTLUCK & GAME NIGHT

Hosted by Todd & Tracy Gulliver

For MUMC adults of all ages

**When: Saturday, February 17,
from 5-9pm**

**Where: Becketwood's Windsor Room
(4300 W. River Pkwy, Mpls)**



Join us for food, fun and conversation at a pizza party potluck. Bring your favorite pizza (from a neighborhood restaurant, the grocery store, or one of your own creations), a side dish and/or a dessert to share. Sample the pizzas and vote for your favorites. We hope you can join us!

To RSVP, email Tracy Gulliver at tracygulliver@gmail.com or call 612-999-9027

AUCTION

Saturday, March 3



Coffee & Doughnuts:

10 AM – 12 Noon

Auction Preview:

10 AM

AUCTION STARTS:

11:01 AM

Lunch Served:

12 Noon – 1:30 PM

Note: Delivery available. Starting at \$25.
All pieces moved day of sale. Storage fee
for anything left at church past Saturday.

**Cabinets, collectibles, housewares, furniture, antiques,
gift certificates, food, crafts, electronics, kids' stuff,
toys, books and who knows what else!**

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 East 50th Street | Minneapolis, MN | 612-721-8231 | www.minnehaha.org

Now's the time to be looking for *gently-used* items in your household that you no longer need, but that could help us raise some money at the Auction! If you have large items, please contact Eric Pederson or Annette Meier and they'll arrange pick-up for you. You can find them most Sunday mornings between services, or can you email/text/call them at : Eric Pederson (952) 250-7444 or ricpederson50@yahoo.com / Annette Meier (612) 597-1778 or salmeier@hotmail.com. We'll be arranging pick-ups after the musical ("The Rockin' Tale of Snow White") mid-February.

Also - please pick up some flyers and distribute/post them at the local businesses in your neighborhood - talk-up this event with your friends and neighbors and plan on joining us for the fun on Sat., March 3rd. This is an all-church event and that we means we need all of you to help us with this great event!

How to Play Ukulele —2nd workshop added! Feb 24 1-3pm

A Workshop by Josh Espinosa, Founder of the Approachable Guitar Project

The ukulele is one of the most accessible musical instruments there is, and it's so affordable that there's practically zero risk in giving it a try. This workshop gets you up and running with the minimal skills you need to start singing and playing songs on the ukulele, and is great for kids (ages 6+) and adults alike.

Plus, you don't even have to own a ukulele to attend the workshop — we'll supply around 10 that attendees can use (or share) during the class.

Contact Josh Espinosa at
josh@approachableguitar.com



WEDNESDAYS at MINNEHAHA UMC

Join us for supper from 5:30-6:30 in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20
PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD
& RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!

Programming for Kids:
From 6:15-7pm each week, elementary students will meet to prepare for Children's Sunday in room 208, preschoolers & kindergartners will have activity time in room 202 & 204.
The Minnehaha Adult Choir Rehearses at 6:45pm in room 310

Our Easter Garden

The Sanctuary will be decorated with flowering spring plants Easter morning. To contribute, please complete this form and bring/mail it to the church office or place it in an offering, with your payment, by March 18.

Given By: _____

Phone: _____

Suggested donation \$20. You may give more if you wish.

Given in:

☐ Memory of ☐ Celebration of ☐ Honor of ☐ other _____

(please print)



(Plants may be taken home after the **11:00** Easter service or during the following week.)



VaLenínes

It's true, Ash Wednesday, the beginning of the season of Lent, falls on Valentine's Day this year. In the numerous conversations I've had about this combination of dates over the last year (yes, this is what clergy talk about when they get together), opinions have varied from how inconvenient this is to how fun it will be to theme an Ash Wednesday service utilizing heart imagery, especially since one of the scriptures used for Ash Wednesday calls on us to rend our hearts, not our garments. Just for the record, we aren't going to be doing that. But, the combination of Valentine's Day and Ash Wednesday is not necessarily a case of opposites. Granted, Valentine's Day focuses on romantic love, but the point of romantic love is to bring out the best in the other person. Love is not about chocolate or flowers or even a good meal. Love is often sacrificial, requires that we put the needs of others above our own wants, and requires hard work and a lot of compromise. Similarly, a relationship with God requires some of the same things. God asks us to put the needs of the whole above our personal wants, it is often hard work to pay attention to, and then do, the things God asks of us. And, God wants us to make sure that we are caring for our souls, caring for our relationship with God, through all of it. That's what Lent is about. Lent is the season to focus on our relationship with God. The things we give up, and the things we take on for Lent are about caring for our souls, feeding our souls, nurturing the relationship we have with God.

We won't be serving chocolate at the Ash Wednesday service. There won't be flowers. And, I will not ask you to write a Valentine's Day card to God. But I do encourage you to think about how you will commemorate Lent this year and the ways in which you will focus on nurturing all your relationships, including your relationship with God.

In joy,
Becky





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2/18



Gifts of the Dark Wood

Lent 2018
at Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We observe a season of contemplation, exploring the wilderness in our lives, and how it impacts our relationship with God and one another.

Ash Wednesday Service:

Wednesday, 14th February at 6:30pm

March Taize Service

Friday, 9th March at 7pm

Sermon Series: Gifts of the Dark Wood

Worship at 9 and 11am on Sundays

Adult Bible Studies: *God's Renewed Creation: Call to Hope and Action*

Mondays at 6:30pm and Thursdays at 10am

Wednesday Evenings:

- All-Church Dinners from 5:30 to 6:30pm
- Programming for Children from 6:15 to 7:00pm
- Adult Choir Rehearsal at 6:45pm

Lenten Personal Dignity Drive for the Minnehaha Food Shelf

Consider bringing the following items with you to worship, or dropping them off at Minnehaha any time throughout the season.

February 18th-24th: Toothpaste and Toothbrushes

February 25th-March 3rd: Toilet Paper

March 4th-10th: Soap - Bar Soap, Shampoo, and Conditioner

March 11th-17th: Deodorant, Razors, and Shaving Cream

March 18th-24th: Feminine Hygiene Products & Newborn-Sized Diapers

Palm Sunday, March 25th: Food Donations

WEDNESDAYS at MINNEHAHA UMC

Join us for supper from 5:30-6:30
in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20

PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD
& RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!

Programming for Kids:
From 6:15-7pm each week, elementary students will
meet to prepare for Children's Sunday in room 208,
preschoolers & kindergartners will have activity time
in room 202 & 204.

The Minnehaha Adult Choir Rehearses
at 6:45pm in room 310

